



Old warhorse: Mohammed Shami found his old-ball craft on a docile Chepauk surface, producing the reverse-swing that proved elusive for the other seamers.



That captaincy managed to get the best out of Shami and Mukesh Kumar in particular, who accounted for five wickets between them. With his name seemingly slipping out of national conversation, Shami provided a timely demonstration of old-ball bowling, proving the only seamer who managed to extract reverse-swing from the pitch, while Mukesh backed him up, nagging away with metronomic consistency.

By contrast, South Zone seemed muddled in its plans as it toiled through the first two days. Its new-ball strategy appeared particularly uncertain, with five fielders pushed out as early as the fifth over of the first session after a brisk start from Vaibhav Sooryavanshi and Abhimanyu

Change of approach: Vaibhav Sooryavanshi was markedly more circumspect in his two stays at the crease.